



The 5 Questions a \$3M–\$30M Household Should Be Asking Their Advisor

A short diagnostic. Use it before your next review meeting, with us or with anyone.

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When a household's finances get complicated, an advisor relationship that isn't working can show up as missed tax planning, estate documents nobody coordinated, and decisions made alone that should have been made as a team. The hard part is that a relationship like that can look fine from the outside. Polite quarterly meetings. Reasonable returns. No obvious problems.

These five questions are designed to surface what's actually happening underneath. Every question is one your advisor should be able to answer without preparation, and one we'd expect to be asked ourselves. There's no gotcha here. Just five conversations a household at this net worth deserves to have.

QUESTION 1 OF 5

How does my fee change as my net worth grows? Show me the math at \$3M, \$10M, and \$20M, in dollars, not percentages.

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER LOOKS LIKE

A concrete dollar figure at each net worth tier, with the methodology explained. If they can't give you a number without "it depends," ask them to walk through their fee structure on the spot using your actual net worth.

QUESTION 2 OF 5

What specifically do you do for me that I couldn't reasonably do myself with 4 hours per quarter and good software?

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER LOOKS LIKE

A list of specific services that require professional judgment: entity structure design, multi-year tax modeling, estate document coordination, insurance strategy across vehicles. If the answer is "we manage your portfolio," ask what their portfolio management adds beyond what a low-cost diversified strategy would deliver, and listen for a specific answer.

QUESTION 3 OF 5

When was the last time you proactively brought me a tax-savings opportunity I wasn't already aware of?

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER LOOKS LIKE

A specific example with a date. "Last March I raised the timing of your Roth conversion before you asked" is proactive. "We always look for opportunities" is marketing language. Ask when in the year they do that work.

QUESTION 4 OF 5

If I died tomorrow, who would my spouse call first, and is that person on speed dial in your office?

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER LOOKS LIKE

A named person, a relationship that already exists, and a documented protocol. The answer should NOT be "we'd help your spouse find an estate attorney." The estate attorney should already be in the workflow before the death happens.

QUESTION 5 OF 5

How do you coordinate with my CPA, estate attorney, and insurance broker, and who's responsible when that coordination fails?

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER LOOKS LIKE

A specific coordination cadence (quarterly tax reviews, annual estate reviews, etc.) and a clear answer about accountability. If "coordination" means "we email them when needed," that's a referral. Real coordination is one team working off one plan.

How did your advisor do?

If all five came back clear, that's a good sign. If two or more came back unclear, the gap is worth looking into. What matters is whether your current relationship fits how complicated your finances are, whoever the advisor is.

If you'd like to talk through what came up, book a 15-minute intro call. We'll go through your answers together. By the end, I'll tell you whether it's worth going deeper in a second conversation, or whether I'm not the right fit.

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[Schedule a 15-minute call](#)